



Democrat Abigail Spanberger was sworn in Saturday as Virginia's 75th governor. She wore suffragist white to the Richmond ceremony.

Spanberger sworn in as first woman to lead Va.

BY GREGORY S. SCHNEIDER AND ERIN COX

RICHMOND — Abigail Davis Spanberger, a former Democratic member of Congress and undercover operative for the CIA, became Virginia's 75th governor Saturday as the first woman chosen to lead a state that waited until 1952 to ratify the federal amendment giving women the right to vote.

"We will not agree on everything," Spanberger said. "But I speak from personal experience when I say we do not have to see eye-to-eye on every issue to stand shoulder-to-shoulder on others."

Spanberger, 46, won a 15-point victory last fall after promising to address the rising con-

New governor urges unity, pledges to tackle rising living costs

sumer costs, job insecurity and lack of access to health care that she blamed on policies enacted in Washington and by the Republican administration of President Donald Trump.

But Spanberger also ran on a record of bipartisanship during her three terms in Congress representing a conservative district, with a reputation for pragmatism that pulled her to the political center at a time of increasing partisan division. Her sweeping

win in a swing state drew national attention from Democrats searching for a message that could resonate broadly in the 2026 midterm elections and beyond.

Within hours of taking office, Spanberger signed 10 executive orders that she said set a tone of pragmatic leadership. One repealed her predecessor's order requiring state law enforcement to cooperate with federal immigration authorities.

She set a theme of unity for Saturday's inauguration, which began at noon on the steps of the Capitol in Richmond — a spot where suffragists demonstrated for the vote more than a century ago.

Spectators assembled on ris-

ers — many wearing clear plastic ponchos handed out by staffers. Spanberger wore a long coat and gloves in suffragist white.

The crowd of roughly 5,000 chanted "Abby! Abby!" and "We love you, Abigail!" as she took the lectern.

"The history and the gravity of this moment are not lost on me," Spanberger told the crowd, which broke into cheers at the mention of suffrage. "I maintain an abiding sense of gratitude to those who worked generation after generation to ensure women could be among those casting ballots, but who could only dream of a day like today."

The chilly, occasionally drizzly day held a series of historic firsts.

SEE SPANBERGER ON A7

Trump to punish nations opposed to Greenland push

NEW TARIFFS OVER SENDING OF TROOPS

Escalation of tensions in quest for 'total' takeover

BY MICHAEL BIRNBAUM AND BRIANNA TUCKER

PALM BEACH, FLA. — The United States will impose tariffs on countries that have sent troops to Greenland in recent days, President Donald Trump said Saturday, dramatically escalating his effort to acquire the Danish territory despite assertions from Greenland and Denmark that the Arctic island is not for sale.

"After Centuries, it is time for Denmark to give back — World Peace is at stake!" Trump wrote on Truth Social.

The move significantly elevates

a confrontation that already threatens to be the largest transatlantic rift in generations. Britain, France, Germany, Norway, Sweden, Finland and the Netherlands have all said in recent days that they would send small numbers of troops to Greenland for joint exercises with the Danish military.

Danish and Greenlandic leaders have said that the United States is welcome to deepen its economic and security involvement in the territory, but they are firmly opposed to U.S. efforts to take it over.

That puts Washington in the position of threatening to grab an ally's territory against its will, risking a fundamental break in the NATO defense alliance. The move could embolden Russia and China to do the same to their neighbors, European diplomats contend.

Most of the countries sending

SEE GREENLAND ON A10

As Gaza 'Board of Peace' takes shape, Israel balks

BY SHIRA RUBIN AND ADELA SULIMAN

TEL AVIV — President Donald Trump named the first members of his "Board of Peace" executive committee to rebuild and revive the devastated Gaza Strip, but the office of Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said the announcement "was not coordinated with Israel" and "runs contrary to its policy."

The initial members include Trump's son-in-law, Jared Kushner, U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio, Middle East envoy Steve Witkoff and former British prime

minister Tony Blair, the White House said in a statement Friday.

Also announced were the members of a secondary operational committee known as the Gaza Executive Board. The board will also include Kushner, Witkoff and Blair, but also Turkish Foreign Minister Hakan Fidan and Qatari diplomat Ali al-Thawadi — leaders from nations that Israeli leaders say will work to ensure Hamas's survival.

"Bringing Qatar and Turkey into the Gaza Strip is a reward to Hamas for the October 7th massacre and a danger to Israel's

SEE GAZA ON A9

Stay-at-home sons embrace living in the family nest

BY SHANE O'NEILL

Brendan Liaw was kind of joking when he agreed he was a professional stay-at-home son during his appearance on "Jeopardy!" in May.

He had just earned a master's degree in political science from the University of British Columbia and had recently sent off a raft of applications to law school. But he was between jobs. And he did live with his parents.

"I figured, why not have some fun with it?" he said. "Better to be a 'stay-at-home son' than 'unemployed' or 'schmuck' or 'lazy guy.'"

He certainly wasn't expecting to set off a media moment of stories and think pieces on so-called trad sons — adult men who embrace the lifestyle of living with their parents.

"I'm sort of the origin of all this discourse," said Liaw, 28. He was speaking from an apartment in Vancouver, British Columbia, where he had recently finished his first semester in law school and his first stint living outside his family's home, with a roommate.

Liaw was tickled by the sudden interest. He describes himself as a guy who is happy to be self-deprecating to get a laugh. "Most

SEE SONS ON A22

Jan. 6 rioter takes punches at Minneapolis rally

Crowd of hundreds of counterprotesters drives provocateur from event

This article is by Daniel Wu, Molly Hennessy-Fiske, Amy B Wang, Rachel Hatzipanagos and Brianna Tucker

MINNEAPOLIS — A right-wing provocateur who was among the pardoned Jan. 6 rioters led a brief anti-immigration demonstration on a frigid Saturday in Minneapolis that ended in a crowd of counterprotesters throwing punches at him as he tried to leave.

A crowd of demonstrators had already gathered outside the Diana E. Murphy federal courthouse downtown by the time Jake Lang and a group of about 10 right-wing protesters arrived at noon. The crowd opposing Lang grew to several hundred and stretched along both sides of South Fourth Street between the courthouse and City Hall.

Lang, who was pardoned along with roughly 1,600 others on the first day of President Donald Trump's second term, announced the Minneapolis protest at a time of heightened tension after the administration dispatched thousands of immigration enforcement agents to the city.

On Saturday, Lang wore a military-style vest with patches that said "Infidel" and "47" — a reference to Trump. Initially, he



JOSHUA LOTT/THE WASHINGTON POST

Jake Lang is beaten Saturday during his anti-immigration demonstration in downtown Minneapolis.

blasted "Ice Ice Baby" in a show of support for the federal immigration enforcement agency, and used a microphone to shout "Go home, Muslims" and "Send the Somalis back," as well as incendiary remarks about how immigrants were "replacing" White Americans.

At one point, Lang climbed into a window well of City Hall above a large crowd opposing him. One counterprotester blasted "Let It Go," a song from the Disney movie "Frozen." Some

threw water balloons and snowballs at Lang, striking him.

The demonstrations took place on a bitterly cold day in Minneapolis and lasted only about an hour before Lang tried to leave. Some counterprotesters yelled out to the crowd to let Lang exit the area, but others shoved and punched him as he pushed his way through the gathering.

Scores of people followed Lang for several blocks, sometimes breaking into a sprint to chase him. Those closest continued to

throw punches at Lang, who was later seen bleeding from the back of his head as he ducked into Hotel Indigo several blocks away. He eventually left through a side door and climbed into a vehicle, which drove away.

Police dressed in riot gear with a SWAT vehicle urged protesters to stay out of the street and on the sidewalks early in the demonstration. They did not appear to closely follow the crowd chasing Lang. After Lang ducked into the hotel,

SEE MINNEAPOLIS ON A12

Allies' pleas, limits of U.S. power held off Iran strike

This article is by Warren P. Strobel, John Hudson, Isaac Arnsdorf, Susannah George, Mohamad El Chamaa and Tara Copp

It was late morning Wednesday and much of the Middle East and official Washington seemed certain President Donald Trump would launch punishing airstrikes against Iran, his second major use of American military power in as many weeks after the daring Delta Force raid into Venezuela to seize leader Nicolás Maduro and his wife.

Trump had not officially given the strike order, but his top security advisers expected him to imminently authorize one of the military options presented to him and were girding themselves for a late night.

The Pentagon advertised that a guided-missile destroyer, the USS Roosevelt, had entered the Persian Gulf. Allies had been alerted that a U.S. strike was likely, according to a person familiar with the matter, and ships and planes were on the move. Personnel at the sprawling al-Udeid U.S. air base in Qatar were advised to evacuate to avoid an expected Iranian counterstrike.

"HELP IS ON ITS WAY," Trump had promised Iranian protesters, encouraging them in a social

SEE IRAN ON A15

SPORTS

The Broncos outlast the Bills in a playoff thriller, 33-30, in overtime. **B1**

BUSINESS

Unserious inspiration for how to give abandoned electronics new life. **B9**



ARTS & STYLE

The definitive ranking of the 26 best neighbors in television sitcom history.

METRO

After U-Va. resignations, Spanberger names 27 to Va. college boards. **B16**



BOOK WORLD

"Lost Lambs" wrings laughs from a zany story about a family in crisis.

TRAVEL

The biggest moments and advancements to traveling this century.

COMICS.....INSERT
OBTUARIES.....B19
OPINION PAGES.....A19
WORLD NEWS.....A14

CONTENT © 2026
The Washington Post / Year 149, No. 54465

